

TASK 4 — MINI PROJECT

IoT IN ROBOTICS AND AUTOMATION

Student	Onimago Ibrahim
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A proposed connected robotic system that uses sensors, edge computing, internet communication and cloud-based monitoring to support intelligent automation, remote supervision and data-driven decisions.

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1. INTRODUCTION

The Internet of Things (IoT) is a technology approach in which physical devices use sensors, processors and communication networks to collect, exchange and act on data. When IoT is integrated with robotics, robots can become connected systems that share operational information with dashboards, servers, other machines and authorized users.

This mini project proposes an IoT-enabled mobile robotic platform for controlled environments such as warehouses, laboratories, smart campuses and small industrial facilities. The robot can collect environmental and machine data, communicate status over a network, receive authorized commands and trigger predefined automation responses.

1.1 Problem Statement

Many robotic systems operate as isolated machines. Without connectivity, operators may have limited visibility into robot status, sensor readings, battery condition, task progress and environmental events. Manual inspection can also make monitoring slower and less scalable. IoT can provide a communication and monitoring layer while keeping immediate safety and control functions local.

1.2 Aim

To design a conceptual IoT-enabled robotics and automation system that connects sensors, an edge controller, a network, cloud services and a monitoring interface while maintaining local automation and safety controls.

1.3 Objectives

- Identify the role of IoT in connected robotics and automation.
- Design a system architecture linking sensing, edge processing, networking, cloud services and users.
- Define a data flow for monitoring, alerts and remote supervision.
- Explain suitable communication, security and safety considerations.
- Propose an implementation and evaluation plan for a small prototype or simulation.

1.4 Significance of the Project

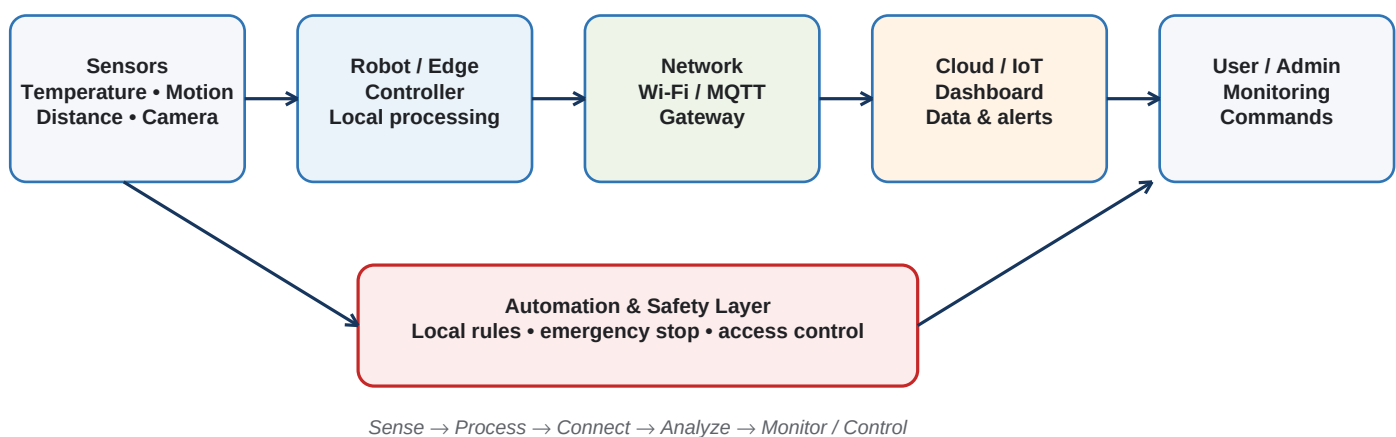
The concept demonstrates how robotics can move from standalone automation toward connected cyber-physical systems. IoT connectivity can support predictive maintenance, remote monitoring, fleet coordination, data logging and operational analytics. The project also emphasizes an important engineering principle: internet connectivity should enhance a robot, not become a single point of failure for safety-critical behavior.

2. PROPOSED IoT ROBOTIC SYSTEM

2.1 System Overview

The proposed robot uses a set of sensors to observe its environment and internal condition. An edge controller processes time-sensitive data locally. A network gateway transfers selected telemetry to an IoT platform, where data can be stored and visualized. Authorized users can view robot status and, where permitted, send non-safety-critical commands. Local safety rules remain active independently of the cloud.

Figure 1. Proposed IoT-Enabled Robotic Automation Architecture



2.2 Main Components

Component	Function
Sensors	Collect distance, motion, temperature, battery or visual data.
Edge controller	Processes sensor data locally and runs immediate automation rules.
Network / gateway	Provides communication between the robot and IoT services.
IoT platform	Receives telemetry, stores data, manages devices and supports analytics.
Dashboard	Displays status, measurements, alerts and permitted controls.
Actuators	Motors, indicators, relays or mechanisms that perform actions.
Security & safety layer	Authentication, authorization, encryption, emergency stop and safe-state logic.

2.3 Communication Approach

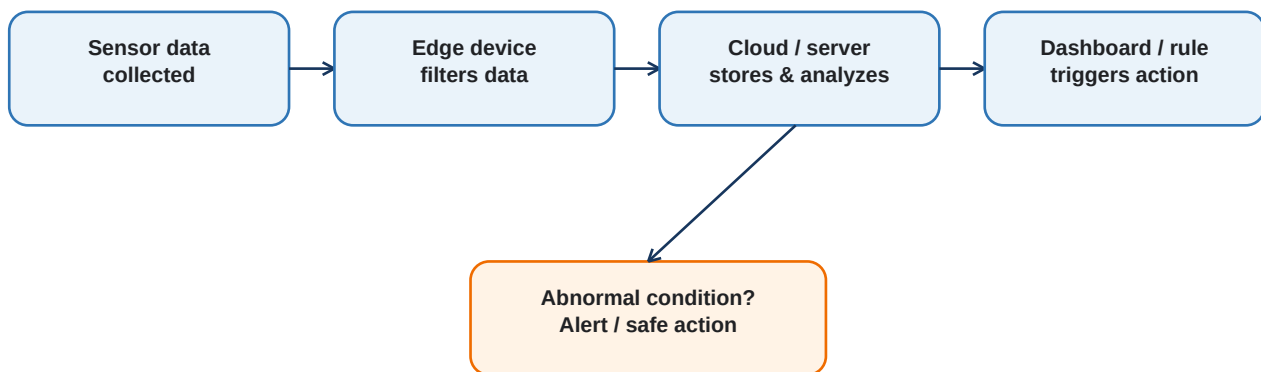
A prototype could use Wi-Fi or another suitable local wireless link. MQTT is a lightweight publish/subscribe protocol commonly used for IoT messaging; an MQTT-based design can publish telemetry topics and subscribe to authorized control topics. The exact network technology should be selected according to range, latency, power consumption, reliability and deployment environment.

3. IoT DATA FLOW, AUTOMATION AND SECURITY

3.1 Data and Control Flow

The system continuously collects selected sensor readings. The edge controller filters or validates the readings and can immediately execute local rules. Suitable telemetry is then transmitted to the IoT platform. The dashboard presents the information to an authorized operator, while rule engines can generate alerts or non-critical automation actions.

Figure 2. IoT Monitoring and Automation Flow



Local safety rules can act even if cloud connectivity is unavailable.

3.2 Example Automation Scenario

Consider a warehouse robot monitoring temperature and obstacle conditions while moving between stations. If the temperature sensor reports an abnormal value, the edge controller can raise a local alert and place the robot in a predefined safe state. The event can also be published to the IoT platform so an authorized operator sees the alert on a dashboard. If connectivity is lost, the local safety response still operates.

3.3 Security Requirements

- Device identity and authentication should prevent unknown devices from joining the system.
- Access control should restrict who can view telemetry and who can issue commands.
- Communication should be protected using appropriate secure protocols and credentials.
- Software and firmware should be updated through controlled procedures.
- Logs should record important events, authentication attempts and command activity.
- Safety-critical functions should not depend solely on a remote server or internet connection.

3.4 Safety and Reliability

Robotic safety must account for mechanical movement, electrical hazards, unexpected obstacles and human interaction. Emergency stop mechanisms, speed limits, obstacle detection, fault handling and human override should be designed into the system. For industrial robot applications, ISO 10218 provides safety requirements for industrial robots and robot applications/cells; the appropriate standard and risk assessment depend on the intended deployment.

4. IMPLEMENTATION PLAN AND APPLICATIONS

4.1 Development Plan

Stage	Work	Output
1	Define robot mission, environment and safety constraints.	Requirements document.
2	Select sensors, controller, actuators and communication method.	System component specification.
3	Build sensor and edge-processing pipeline.	Local monitoring prototype.
4	Connect telemetry to IoT platform and dashboard.	Connected data pipeline.
5	Implement alerts, authorized commands and safety rules.	Automation logic.
6	Test faults, connectivity loss and normal operation.	Evaluation results and improvements.

4.2 Applications

- Warehouse robotics — connected monitoring of mobile robots and task status.
- Smart agriculture — remote sensing and automation in controlled field or greenhouse environments.
- Industrial monitoring — collecting machine/environment data and coordinating robotic tasks.
- Healthcare support environments — asset monitoring and controlled logistics where safety and privacy requirements are met.
- Education and research — experimentation with sensors, MQTT/IoT platforms, dashboards and robotics.

4.3 Evaluation Metrics

Metric	Evaluation question
Telemetry reliability	How consistently does the system deliver valid sensor data?
Response latency	How quickly does a dashboard command or alert propagate?
Connectivity recovery	Does the robot return to normal communication after a network interruption?
Safety response	Does the robot enter the intended safe state during faults?
Energy use	How does sensing and communication affect operating time?

5. EXPECTED OUTCOMES, LIMITATIONS AND CONCLUSION

5.1 Expected Outcomes

The proposed project should demonstrate a clear connection between physical robotics and IoT services. A successful prototype or simulation would collect sensor data, process important information locally, transmit selected telemetry, display robot status on a dashboard and trigger defined alerts or actions. The architecture should also demonstrate that local safety behavior continues during communication failures.

5.2 Advantages

- Remote visibility of robot and environmental status.
- Centralized logging and analysis of operational data.
- Faster detection of abnormal conditions through alerts.
- Potential support for predictive maintenance and fleet management.
- Scalable architecture in which additional devices can be connected through the same IoT platform.

5.3 Limitations

- Network interruptions can reduce remote monitoring capability.
- Poor sensor quality can produce inaccurate data.
- Cybersecurity weaknesses may expose devices or data if the system is poorly configured.
- Cloud services introduce dependency, cost and latency considerations.
- Physical robot deployment requires detailed mechanical, electrical and safety engineering beyond this conceptual proposal.

5.4 Future Improvements

- Add machine-learning analytics for anomaly detection and predictive maintenance.
- Integrate multiple robots into a coordinated IoT fleet.
- Add digital-twin simulation for testing before physical deployment.
- Improve edge AI so more decisions can be made locally.
- Use stronger device-management, monitoring and cybersecurity practices.

5.5 Conclusion

IoT can significantly extend the usefulness of robotics by connecting robots to sensors, networks, data platforms and authorized users. The proposed IoT-enabled robotic system combines local sensing and control with connected monitoring and analytics. Its architecture emphasizes a practical balance: connectivity provides visibility and coordination, while local rules and safety mechanisms preserve predictable behavior when network services are unavailable. With controlled testing, cybersecurity and application-specific risk assessment, this concept can serve as a foundation for connected robotics and automation projects.

5.6 References

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Project status: Conceptual mini project / technical proposal. A physical prototype is not claimed unless separately built and tested.